



HOW TO RAISE *CHILDREN*

ACCORDING TO THE BIBLE

LEARNING WORKBOOK

BECOMING HER

Love. Discipline. Teach. Model. Pray.

A practical study for parents, with eight core lessons, Bible readings, everyday examples and space to reflect.

The goal is not simply obedience. It is to nurture character, teach love for God and others, and create a home where children can learn, grow and remain securely loved.

Grace + discipline

Family name: _____

Started: _____

BEFORE YOU BEGIN

How to use this guide

Study one lesson at a time. Read the Bible passage and its surrounding verses, consider the example and choose one manageable action. Repeat the lesson when your family needs practice.

This workbook expands and reorganises the eight principles in your original parenting guide. Scripture is given as reading references. Explanations, examples and exercises are applications rather than direct biblical quotations.

Adapt expectations to each child's age, understanding and needs. A child who is overwhelmed, tired or struggling to process instructions may need support before correction.

Start with connection, give a clear limit, teach the next step and repair when needed. Firm boundaries and warmth belong together.

Children learn gradually. Difficult days do not erase progress, and parents can begin again too. Use these pages for honest reflection rather than scoring your worth as a parent.

STUDY MAP

Your parenting journey

01 Teach them about God in everyday life

02 Correct them with love

03 Teach obedience and respect

04 Teach kindness and forgiveness

05 Let them experience healthy consequences

06 Be the example you want them to follow

07 Create an emotionally safe home

08 Pray with them and for them

After the lessons: Grace and discipline • Family rules • A daily rhythm A correction plan • Weekly reflection • Family prayer

LESSON 01 OF 8

Teach them about God in everyday life

READ IN YOUR BIBLE

Deuteronomy 6:6-7

THE PRINCIPLE

Make faith part of ordinary family life: at breakfast, on the way to school, during play and before bed. Young children do not need a long sermon. A brief story, a prayer or a moment of gratitude gives them something concrete to understand. Let questions be welcome.

AN EVERYDAY EXAMPLE

At bedtime, ask each child to name one thing they are thankful to God for and one person they would like to pray for. Listen without correcting every word.

REFLECT HONESTLY

When could a short, warm conversation about God fit naturally into our day?

PUT IT INTO PRACTICE

Choose one daily moment for a two-minute faith habit. Keep it simple enough to repeat.

ADAPT TO YOUR CHILD

Younger child: name something God made. Older child: connect a Bible story to a kind choice at school.

MY OBSERVATIONS AND PRAYER

LESSON 02 OF 8

Correct them with love

READ IN YOUR BIBLE

Ephesians 6:4; Proverbs 13:24

THE PRINCIPLE

Discipline should teach, guide and protect. State a clear boundary, help the child calm down and use a reasonable consequence when needed. Correct what happened without labelling the child bad. The rod imagery in Proverbs is interpreted differently across Christian traditions; this workbook applies discipline through nonviolent guidance, without humiliation or fear.

AN EVERYDAY EXAMPLE

Instead of saying, You are naughty, say: Hitting is not allowed. I will help you stop. Sit with me until you are calm, then we will make it right.

REFLECT HONESTLY

Do my corrections teach a skill, or mainly express my frustration?

PUT IT INTO PRACTICE

Prepare one calm phrase for a repeated problem. Practise it before the next difficult moment.

ADAPT TO YOUR CHILD

Younger child: use a short instruction and close support. Older child: explain the boundary and practise an alternative response.

MY OBSERVATIONS AND PRAYER

LESSON 03 OF 8

Teach obedience and respect

READ IN YOUR BIBLE

Ephesians 6:1-3

THE PRINCIPLE

Teach listening, honesty, kindness and responsibility with clear, age-appropriate expectations. Give one instruction at a time, allow time to process it and acknowledge effort. Respect also includes listening to children. Teach that they may tell a trusted adult about anything frightening or unsafe, even if an adult has told them to keep it secret.

AN EVERYDAY EXAMPLE

Say: Please put your shoes away now. Wait, offer help if needed and notice when the child follows through. Avoid giving five instructions at once.

REFLECT HONESTLY

Are my expectations clear and realistic for this child today?

PUT IT INTO PRACTICE

Choose one everyday instruction to practise calmly and consistently for a week.

ADAPT TO YOUR CHILD

Younger child: demonstrate and do the first step together. Older child: ask them to repeat the plan in their own words.

MY OBSERVATIONS AND PRAYER

LESSON 04 OF 8

Teach kindness and forgiveness

READ IN YOUR BIBLE

Matthew 22:37-39

THE PRINCIPLE

Love for God and others becomes practical through empathy and repair. When siblings argue, first stop harm and help them settle. Then talk about what happened, how the other person felt and what can make things right. Forgiveness can take time; it does not require accepting repeated harm or unwanted affection.

AN EVERYDAY EXAMPLE

Ask: What happened? How did your brother feel? What can you do to help?
Encourage an honest apology and a helpful action rather than forcing empty words.

REFLECT HONESTLY

How can I help my children understand the impact of their actions?

PUT IT INTO PRACTICE

Practise a repair sequence: name the action, acknowledge the hurt, apologize and offer help.

ADAPT TO YOUR CHILD

Younger child: help return a toy or check on a sibling. Older child: describe the harm and suggest a fair repair.

MY OBSERVATIONS AND PRAYER

LESSON 05 OF 8

Let them experience healthy consequences

READ IN YOUR BIBLE

Proverbs 22:6

THE PRINCIPLE

Use safe natural consequences or logical consequences connected to the behaviour. Keep them reasonable, predictable and short enough for the child to understand. Never withhold food, affection, safety or basic needs. The proverb describes the value of training; it is not a guarantee of a particular adult outcome.

AN EVERYDAY EXAMPLE

If a toy is deliberately thrown after a clear limit, put it away briefly. If a child intentionally spills something, help them clean it. Then teach how to try again.

REFLECT HONESTLY

Is this consequence connected to the behaviour, and what will it teach?

PUT IT INTO PRACTICE

Write one common behaviour beside a reasonable consequence and the skill you want to teach.

ADAPT TO YOUR CHILD

Younger child: help clean with you immediately. Older child: take a larger share of the repair, with supervision when needed.

MY OBSERVATIONS AND PRAYER

LESSON 06 OF 8

Be the example you want them to follow

READ IN YOUR BIBLE

1 Corinthians 11:1

THE PRINCIPLE

Children learn by observing how you pray, speak, handle disappointment, tell the truth and treat others. You do not need to model perfection. Let them see honest accountability and repair. Paul calls believers to follow his example as he follows Christ; this guide applies that principle to parenting.

AN EVERYDAY EXAMPLE

After shouting, return when calm and say: I was wrong to shout. I am sorry. You did not cause my shouting. Next time I will pause and speak more calmly.

REFLECT HONESTLY

Which habit of mine would I most want my children to copy?

PUT IT INTO PRACTICE

Choose one behaviour to model deliberately this week: patience, honesty, apology or practical kindness.

ADAPT TO YOUR CHILD

Younger child: demonstrate taking a breath and trying again. Older child: explain your mistake without making them responsible for your emotions.

MY OBSERVATIONS AND PRAYER

LESSON 07 OF 8

Create an emotionally safe home

READ IN YOUR BIBLE

Colossians 3:21

THE PRINCIPLE

Correction should never suggest that love is withdrawn. Avoid shame, cruel language, threats and uncontrolled anger. Feelings can be accepted while harmful behaviour is stopped. Help children name emotions and learn safer responses. Notice whether they feel able to tell you the truth when they have made a mistake.

AN EVERYDAY EXAMPLE

Say: I love you. It is okay to feel angry, but I will not let you hit. We can calm down and solve this together.

REFLECT HONESTLY

Do my children know they can come to me with a mistake or a worry?

PUT IT INTO PRACTICE

Create a calming routine: stay nearby, lower your voice, allow space and reconnect before discussing repair.

ADAPT TO YOUR CHILD

Younger child: name the feeling and offer simple choices. Older child: invite them to explain when ready without demanding an immediate conversation.

MY OBSERVATIONS AND PRAYER

LESSON 08 OF 8

Pray with them and for them

READ IN YOUR BIBLE

Philippians 4:6

THE PRINCIPLE

Pray in gratitude, joy, uncertainty and difficulty. Use familiar language and let children contribute without performing. Pray privately for their character, protection and wisdom. Teach that prayer can accompany practical help and that difficult feelings or unanswered questions are welcome.

AN EVERYDAY EXAMPLE

Before bed, thank God for the day, ask forgiveness for a mistake, pray for someone you love and ask for help tomorrow. A child may listen if they do not want to speak.

REFLECT HONESTLY

Does prayer feel like a warm invitation in our home?

PUT IT INTO PRACTICE

Begin a short bedtime prayer habit and let each child choose a person or situation to include.

ADAPT TO YOUR CHILD

Younger child: one sentence of thanks. Older child: a thank-you, a concern and a request for wisdom.

MY OBSERVATIONS AND PRAYER

INTEGRATION

Grace + discipline

A Christian home does not demand perfection. Children will argue, make mistakes and struggle. The message is both: my actions have consequences, and I am still loved.

Grace means a mistake does not become a child's identity. Discipline means you help them understand the boundary, repair harm and practise a better choice.

When emotions run high, stop unsafe behaviour first. Help the child settle before expecting a thoughtful explanation. Afterwards, teach and reconnect.

If you lose your patience, repair your own behaviour too. An apology does not cancel a reasonable limit; it shows that everyone is accountable for how they treat others.

A PHRASE TO REMEMBER

I love you. This behaviour is not okay. I will help you make it right.

WHERE DOES OUR FAMILY NEED MORE GRACE? WHERE DO WE NEED A CLEARER BOUNDARY?

FAMILY WORKSHEET

Simple rules for every day

1. Love God Make room for gratitude, prayer and learning.
2. Tell the truth Speak honestly, even when you made a mistake.
3. Listen to Mum and Dad Follow safe, clear instructions; ask when you do not understand.
4. Be kind Use gentle hands and respectful words.
5. Help each other Contribute in small ways that suit your age.
6. Forgive and repair Say sorry honestly, help make it right and allow time to heal.
7. Care for what God has given us Look after toys, our home, other people and the world around us.

THE RULE WE WILL PRACTISE THIS WEEK

FAMILY WORKSHEET

A simple daily rhythm

MORNING

Offer a warm greeting. Give one clear instruction. Pray briefly for wisdom and kindness.

AFTER SCHOOL

Reconnect before questioning or correcting. Offer food, rest and a chance to share.

DURING A DIFFICULT MOMENT

Stop harm, stay calm, name the limit and help the child settle. Teach and repair afterwards.

AT BEDTIME

Share a thankful moment, a concern and a short prayer. End with reassurance of love.

OUR DAILY FAITH HABIT

ONE ROUTINE WE WILL SIMPLIFY

PARENT WORKSHEET

Plan a calm correction

The repeated behaviour I want to address:

What might my child need help with?

The clear, simple boundary I will state:

A reasonable, connected consequence, if needed:

The skill or repair we will practise together:

How I will reconnect and reassure my child:

WEEKLY REFLECTION

Notice growth and begin again

A moment of kindness or honesty I noticed:

A moment when I modelled the behaviour I want to teach:

A difficult moment and what it showed me:

Something I need to apologize for or repair:

One small change we will practise next week:

Notice effort: You told the truth even though it was hard. Notice repair: You helped clean up and tried again.

PRAYER AND PURPOSE

Build a home of love and wisdom

Lord, help me raise my children with love, wisdom and patience. Teach me to set clear boundaries without cruelty, to listen before reacting and to model what I ask of them. Help our children grow in kindness, honesty, courage and faith. When we make mistakes, help us repent, repair and begin again. Let our home be a place where truth is welcome and love is secure. Amen.

A SHORT PRAYER WITH CHILDREN

Dear God, thank you for today. Help us be kind, tell the truth and care for each other. Forgive our mistakes and help us make things right. Please look after the people we love. Amen.

OUR FAMILY PRAYER REQUESTS

Love them. Guide them. Model the way. Keep God at the centre of your home.